

PREMIER LEAGUE SPENDING V.S. PERFORMANCE

DATA-3400 DATA VISUALIZATION NARRATIVE

NAME: Will Braucher
DATE: 10-15-24

1. QUESTION / PURPOSE

How does team spending correlate with league performance in the Premier league?

2. AUDIENCE

My general audience would be soccer analysts, club managers, financial directors, sports journalists, soccer fans, soccer scouts and any recruitment teams for the clubs. If I were to narrow it down, I would say the chief financial officer of a soccer team. The CFO would care about maximizing the return on investment, Spending the clubs' budget effectively for results. Understanding how a club's spending compares to those on a similar level and finding a competitive advantage. The benefits if my audience acts the way I want them to would be allocation of funds more effectively to improve performance. Refining transfer decisions for safer and reliable recruitment. Better long-term financial strategies. The risk would be falling behind to competitors, missed talent opportunity, stakeholder discontent and financial instability.

3. SINGLE SENTENCE

Analyze how team spending correlates with league performance in the Premier League to identify which investments lead to better standings.

4. DATA

I will use datasets from sources like Deloitte.com, football-observatory.com, footballbenchmark.com, and the Annual Review of Football Finance 2024. Additionally, I'll use Transfermarkt.us for league table data, which will require cleaning and mining. It will also give me the value of players from the summer of 2022. This includes transfer fees and market value.

5. CHART TYPES + UNITS

I think bar charts would be great for my project as well as line charts. I want to make clear comparisons and show overtime how revenue and the increase/decrease in transfer budgets has effected each team. For visualizing the standings, I plan to use a spatial map of Europe where the darker the color the better the team is positionally. I want to use comparison chart types, correlation, and data over time. Using these would make it easier for my audience to really get good insight from my data than some of the other chart types.

6. LOCATION IS EVERYTHING

Instead of a geographical map, I will use a soccer field to show spending by position. The map will illustrate areas where teams invest the most—such as forwards, midfielders, defenders, or goalkeepers—and how this spending correlates with league standings. If possible, I'll integrate Tableau features to allow interactivity, such as clicking on a position to reveal additional details about the top-spending teams and their performance.

7. PROCESS

10/15/24 I wanted to explore what insights my data could provide, so I began by dropping dimensions and measures into Tableau. During this process, I noticed some null values for certain teams. Upon investigation, I found that the issue stemmed from inconsistent club names across the data sources. To resolve this, I copied and pasted the corrected names into each Excel file to ensure consistency. Additionally, I realized that I didn't have date information to format properly. To address this, I decided to focus my analysis on the summer transfer window of 2022 and the respective league finishes for that season.

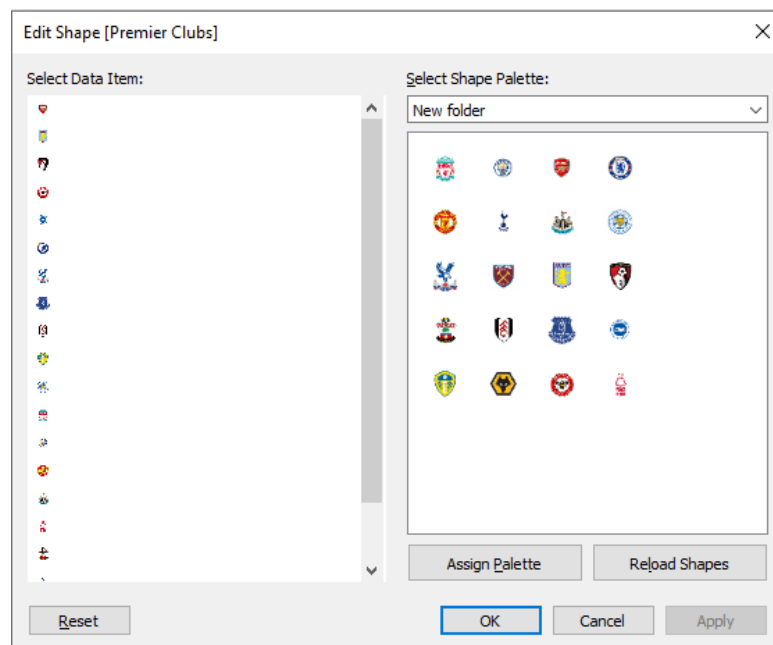
10/23/24 I decided I wanted this to be one of the graphs I use for my dashboard because it is very informative and it shows many aspects of my data that I want to show including the wage spending, league performance and Cost per point for the teams on size. It also includes some of the Gestalt principles.



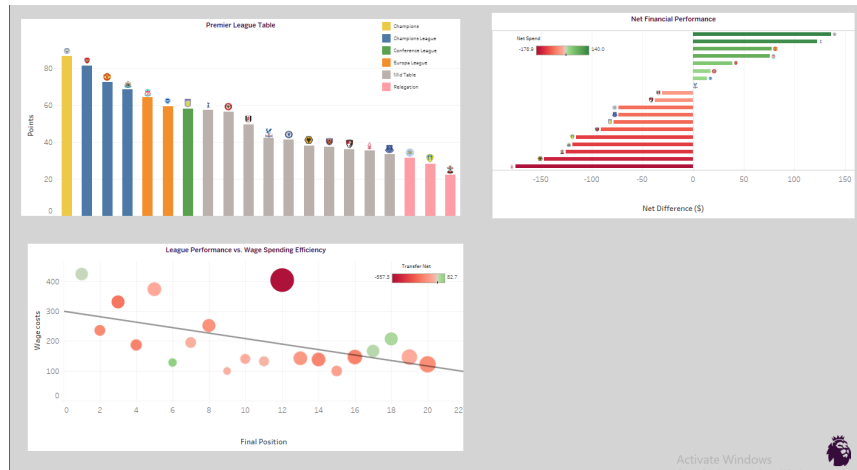
10/27/24 I have had to figure out how I want to reconfigure my cost per point as my previous version included players the clubs have sold so I have fixed these using calculations and creating new fields for my design such as expenditures.



- 11/12/24 I have added a lot of graphs and visualizations now, but I am unsure what else I want to add to my dashboard. I think I need to focus more on the finances of specifically 2022.
- 11/19/24 I have gotten feedback on my project from my peers and adding more complex charts is needed and making changes to my charts and adding a part to the whole. Ethan also suggested that I need to have 5-6 charts and then decide from there. I need to narrow it down more.
- 11/24/24 I want to add the premier league clubs as logos for my bar graphs because I think it will be easier for my audience to just look at the badge than read the name off it. I need to add this using the files for tableau and add it to shapes.

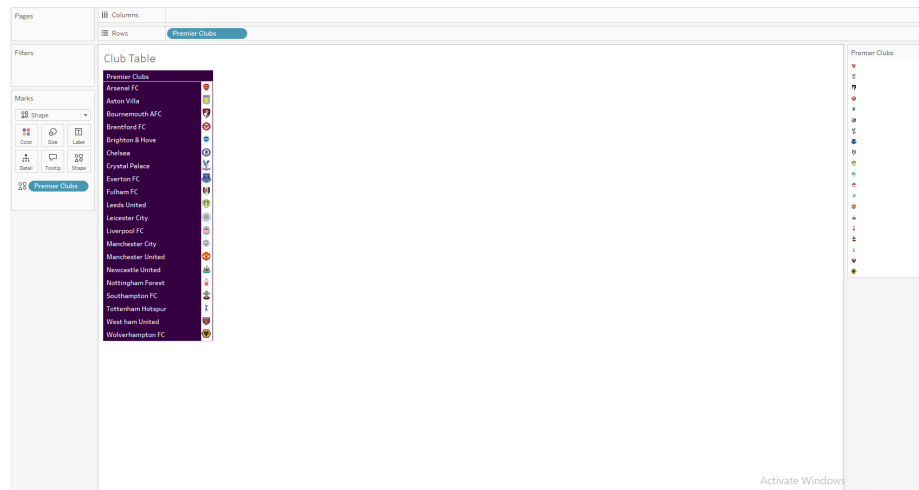


- 11/27/24 I have started to build my dashboard but haven't touched my map yet. I am still unsure how to finish that portion of the project.



11/28/24

I want to add more interactivity to my dashboard by using filters and highlights. Since I don't have my mapping yet what I want to do is incorporate a table where you can highlight and filter by just pressing the teams. This will make it simple for anyone who wants to see how their team is doing with finances and how they stack up against the competition.



12/3/24

I have finally figured out how to add my interactive map to my project. First, I downloaded a soccer field and then I manually add x and y values to my data based on the size of my image. I put the x and y values so that it would look like an actual soccer team and formation it took a bit of trial and error, but it finally worked out well.



12/3/24

I got some great feedback about my presentation from Dr. Hagman:

Purpose: Clear

Audience: very clear audience.

Credibility

- good mastery of what your data means, clear explanation
- Good discussion of why Chelsea was removed
- Financial fairplay / Debt ratio financial solvency good explanation
- data has a lot of depth and meaning

Design

- Good use of icons
- Good use of consistent color meaning, with one exception, Regulation. Change the red tone so that the color isn't the same as the others
- Make sure all borders are aligned.

Story

- Good explanation of the importance of relegation
- Good use of highlight and tool tip
- Perhaps add the final sentence to top right of this is their deficit/gain

Additional feedback provided was to increase the title size and change the background for my image of the soccer field so that it doesn't have a water mark.